

Unai Fischer Abaigar

Data Science Assistant Professor / Faculty Fellow, New York University

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[Google Scholar](#)

Academic Appointments

New York University

Data Science Assistant Professor / Faculty Fellow, Center for Data Science

New York, NY

2026–present

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Visiting Student, Laboratory for Information and Decision Systems

Hosted by Sendhil Mullainathan and Juan Carlos Perdomo.

Cambridge, MA

Apr–May 2026

Institute for Employment Research (IAB)

Guest Researcher

Nuremberg, Germany

Sep 2025–Jul 2026

Harvard University

Fellow, Harvard SEAS and CRCS

Hosted by Cynthia Dwork and Juan Carlos Perdomo.

Cambridge, MA

Sep–Dec 2024

Hertie School Data Science Lab

Research Associate

Berlin, Germany

May–Jul 2022

Education

LMU Munich

Ph.D. (Dr. rer. nat.) in Statistics, magna cum laude

Dissertation: *Foundations of Prediction in the Public Sphere*.

Advised by Frauke Kreuter and Christoph Kern, with Avi Feller and Julia Stoyanovich serving as examiners.

Affiliation: [Munich Center for Machine Learning \(MCML\)](#).

Munich, Germany

2026

Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg

M.Sc. in Physics

Heidelberg, Germany

2022

Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg

B.Sc. in Physics

Heidelberg, Germany

2020

Honors and Awards

LMU-NYU Research Cooperation Program

- EUR 10,000 in project funding for *Foundations of Statistical Prediction in the Public Sphere*.

2025

ICML Outstanding Paper Award

- One of six papers selected; awarded for *The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off*.

2025

Konrad Zuse School for Excellence in Reliable AI

- Doctoral fellowship and advanced training program.

2023–2026

German Academic Scholarship Foundation (*Studienstiftung*)

- Scholarship awarded to fewer than 0.5% of German students.

2016–2020

Publications

- **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Emily Aiken, Christoph Kern, and Juan Carlos Perdomo. “On the Meta-Design of Allocation Problems.” Preprint, 2026.
- Julian Rodemann, **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, James Bailie, and Krikamol Muandet. “Performative Learning Theory.” *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2026.

- **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Christoph Kern, and Juan Carlos Perdomo. “The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off.” *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2025. **Outstanding Paper Award**; highlight track at FORC 2025.
- Christoph Kern, **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Jonas Schweisthal, Dennis Frauen, Rayid Ghani, Stefan Feuerriegel, Mihaela van der Schaar, and Frauke Kreuter. “Algorithms for Reliable Decision-Making Need Causal Reasoning.” *Nature Computational Science*, 2025.
- **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Christoph Kern, Noam Barda, and Frauke Kreuter. “Bridging the Gap: Towards an Expanded Toolkit for AI-Driven Decision-Making in the Public Sector.” *Government Information Quarterly* 41(4), 2024.
- **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Christoph Kern, and Frauke Kreuter. “The Missing Link: Allocation Performance in Causal Machine Learning.” *ICML Workshop on Humans, Algorithmic Decision-Making and Society*, 2024.
- Christian Götzl, Selina Hiller, Christian Rauschenberg, Anita Schick, Janik Fechtelpeter, **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Georgia Koppe, Daniel Durstewitz, Ulrich Reininghaus, and Silvia Krumm. “Artificial Intelligence-Informed Mobile Mental Health Apps for Young People: A Mixed-Methods Approach on Users’ and Stakeholders’ Perspectives.” *Child and Adolescent Psychiatry and Mental Health* 16, 2022.

Talks

<i>Understanding the Value of Prediction in Allocation</i> EAAMO Bridges Inequality Working Group, virtual	Mar 2026
<i>The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off</i> ICML, oral presentation, Vancouver	Jul 2025
<i>Adjusting Survey Estimates Using Multiaccuracy Postprocessing</i> ITACOSM, Bologna	Jul 2025
<i>The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off</i> FORC, Stanford University	Jun 2025
<i>The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off</i> Social Foundations of Computation, Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems, Tübingen	May 2025
<i>Algorithmic Decision-Making in the Public Sector</i> Theory of Computation Graduate Student Seminar, Harvard University	Oct 2024
<i>Introduction to Automated Decision-Making</i> Coleridge Initiative, University of Maryland	Oct 2024
<i>Machine Learning for Reliable Decision-Making</i> Zuse Industry Workshop on Algorithmic Decision-Making	Apr 2024
<i>Challenges for ML-Supported Decision-Making</i> Department of Statistics Seminar, LMU Munich	Jan 2024

Teaching

LMU Munich

<i>Advanced Methods in Social Statistics and Social Data Science</i> Co-instructor	Summer 2024, 2025
<i>Machine Learning Meets Causality</i> Co-instructor	Winter 2023
<i>Computational Social Science</i> Teaching assistant	Winter 2022, 2023, 2025

Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg

<i>Machine Learning for Real-World Challenges</i> Teaching assistant	Summer 2022
<i>Dynamical Systems Theory in Machine Learning and Data Science</i> Teaching assistant	Winter 2021

Professional Service and Outreach

Conference reviewer: ICML; NeurIPS	
Member, EAAMO Bridges Inequality Working Group	2026
Co-organizer, Data Science for Social Good Munich	2022–2024
Organizing team, DataFest Germany	2023, 2025